

"News, rumors, revelations,
and prophecies from the age
of artificial intelligence."

The Ai Times

Editorial Board:
Alshival.Ai



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An Ai Company in a World That Hates Ai

Alshival.Ai has been advertising a lot lately and, well, we are an Ai company in a world that hates Ai. We get it. We also hate Ai sometimes—especially when a company replaces its customer-service representatives with a bot that cannot answer our question and refuses to transfer us to someone who can.

That is not a failure of the public to appreciate innovation. It is a reasonable response to bad implementation. A 2026 **Gartner survey** found that 87% of customers believe companies using generative Ai for customer service must provide access to a human. People want an emergency exit when the machine catches fire.

Customer service is only the most familiar complaint. People are tired of Ai advertisements, generated books, synthetic voices, fake photographs, and social-media feeds swollen with misleading content. The internet has settled on a name for it: Ai slop.

Our Own Comments Section

We did not have to search far for the backlash. Knowing that people hate Ai-generated advertisements, we did what any sensible Ai company would do: we published one anyway.

The reviews arrived promptly. One person wrote "nice water waste." Another awarded us "Certified AI Bullshit." One pleaded, "gotte helf mir WHY DO SO MANY ADS USE AI." Someone posted a photograph of a book titled *How to Stop using Ai*. The sharpest response was also the simplest: "Sometimes it's not our turn to talk." I should probably have that framed.

I was rolling on the floor. The ad was terrible—certified slop—and rage-baiting the public had been my intention. The public graciously supplied the rage. My team was less delighted. "Maybe we shouldn't publish any more Ai-generated ads," they suggested while surveying the wreckage.

The comments were funny, but not ran-

dom. They expressed exhaustion, environmental concern, distrust of synthetic marketing, and resentment toward companies using Ai merely because they can. Every new tool gives us another way to speak. It does not give us something worth saying.

A 2025 **Pew Research Center survey** found that 50% of Americans were more concerned than excited about Ai in daily life; only 10% were more excited than concerned. An **advertising-industry survey** found a similar gap: advertisers were far more optimistic about Ai ads than the young people watching them, who were more likely to see the brands as fake, inauthentic, or unethical.

Literature is more personal. A reader opens a book expecting to encounter another mind, not merely grammatical sentences. The **Authors Guild** reports that online stores are filling with generated books and knockoffs that borrow real authors' names. Writers object to their work training systems that now compete for their readers. The problem is not only bad writing. The entire transaction can be deceptive.

The complaints share a theme: Ai is imposed without consent, disclosure, recourse, or a clear benefit. The company saves money while everyone else inherits the frustration.

I recently met with a new client who wants our help launching a platform. One line from the engagement notes stood out: "Avoid Silicon Valley positioning: audiences are skeptical of AI-first branding right now." Good. Skepticism should shape the launch. An experimental company can admit what works, what does not, and where it needs help. That is stronger than calling an unfinished feature magic.

The Tool Is Not the Strategy

Ai is not so different from the tools used by cavemen. A tool extends what a person can do; it does not decide what should be done. The issue is the person or organization using it, the incentives guiding them, and the judgment exercised when it fails.

There is a Hindi saying: नाच न जाने आँगन टेढ़ा (*naach na jaane, aangan tedha*)—the one who cannot dance blames the

courtyard for being crooked. Its English equivalent is "A bad workman quarrels with his tools." We must examine the tool, but also the worker who chose it and the job they chose it for.

Did Ai extend someone's judgment, or replace it with a plausible approximation? Did it remove drudgery, or remove the worker? Is a human still responsible for the result? Those questions matter more than whether the marketing department can attach "AI-powered" to the product name.

Ai can retrieve account history and help a service representative respond without replacing the representative. It can organize a writer's research without claiming authorship. It can help a creative team explore an idea without pretending that prompting replaces the team. The technology should serve the worker and the audience, not become an excuse to discard them.

An Ai strategy cannot begin with "Where can we add Ai?" It must begin with the problem. What is the user trying to accomplish? What happens when the model is wrong? When should a human take over? These questions separate a useful tool from an expensive annoyance.

Earn the Right to Use It

An organization does not earn trust by calling itself Ai-first. It earns trust by being customer-first, employee-first, or problem-first. For our new client's platform, that means launching around real workflows, listening to early users, and letting the technology prove its value.

We are still an Ai company. But we cannot demand that the world love Ai. We have to build things people can love, explain how they work, and take responsibility when they do not. In a world that hates Ai, the companies that succeed may be the ones that stop making Ai the hero of every story.

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